Smart Partner

How XJTLU Year 1 Students Actually Use an AI Learning Agent

ADS401 · Presentation 2 | Group C

Research Questions

1. Among XJTLU Year 1 students, what is the **breadth** (ever used?) and **depth** (sessions per week, minutes per session) of Smart Partner use?
2. Do the four EAP levels — **A** (foundation), **B / C** (core), **High Level** (advanced) — differ in adoption rate and weekly use frequency?
3. Is students' **use frequency** correlated with their **self-rated EAP confidence**?
4. Do students use Smart Partner mainly as an **exam-sprint tool**, or to build **long-term study habits**?

Figures on this deck are placeholders. Replace them with collected results before submission.

Target Group & Sampling

Target group. XJTLU Year 1 students currently enrolled on EAP, spanning all four levels and drawn from arts, science and engineering programmes.

Level	Stream	n	Share
A	Foundation	_____	_____%
B	Core	_____	_____%
C	Core	_____	_____%
High Level	Advanced	_____	_____%

Sampling. Convenience sampling (non-probability): the questionnaire link was distributed through EAP class groups and year-group chats.

- Distributed: _____
- Returned: _____
- Valid after cleaning: _____
- Response rate: _____%

> Limitation: cell sizes are uneven because the core stream holds most students. Non-parametric tests are therefore reported alongside the parametric ones.

Study Design

A cross-sectional, non-experimental survey: usage and attitude data collected at a single time point. No variable is manipulated, so findings are correlational rather than causal.

Experiment plan

1. Background review & research questions
2. Instrument design (questionnaire + interview guide)
3. Pilot test with ~12 students; revise wording
4. Fieldwork via class group chats
5. Data cleaning & coding
6. Descriptive then inferential analysis
7. Visualisation, presentation & reflection

Data types collected

Level	Variables	Analysis
Nominal	EAP level, ever used, faculty	Counts, chi-square
Ordinal	Frequency band, confidence 1–10, Likert	Median, Wilcoxon
Scale	Sessions / week, minutes per session	Mean, SD, ANOVA, Pearson *r*
Textual	Open answers, interview transcripts	Thematic coding

Instruments

Questionnaire (6–8 minutes)

1. Which EAP level are you in? A / B / C / High Level
2. Have you used Smart Partner? Yes / No → skip to Q8
3. Sessions per week numeric
4. Minutes per session banded
5. Features used most multi-select
6. Main purpose of use multi-select
7. Confidence about passing EAP 1–10
8. Biggest improvement needed? open

Interview guide (15 minutes, semi-structured)

1. How did you first come across Smart Partner?
2. Describe one time it was especially helpful — or useless.
3. Would you recommend it to a classmate? Why?
4. Has it changed how you prepare for EAP?
5. If one feature could be added, what would it be?

> Every participant read the **information sheet** and ticked the **consent form** before answering. Both are reproduced in the supplementary materials.

Results 1 — Usage

Indicator	Result
Ever used Smart Partner	_____% (_____/_____)
Sessions per week (users)	M = _____, SD = _____
Minutes per session	≈ _____ min
Used more in the pre-exam week	_____%

[Figure 1] Adoption rate by EAP level — insert bar chart here.

[Figure 2] Distribution of use frequency.

[Figure 3] Feature adoption rates — most versus least used functions.

[Figure 4] Stated purposes of use: exam-oriented versus habit-building.

Results 2 — Statistical Tests

Research question	Test chosen	Why this test	Statistic	p	Verdict
Is adoption independent of EAP level?	Chi-square test of independence	Categorical × categorical, 4 × 2	$\chi^2(3) =$ _____, V = _____	_____	_____
Does weekly use differ across the four levels?	One-way ANOVA	1 IV, 4 conditions, between-group	F(3, _____) = _____, η^2 = _____	_____	_____
Is use frequency related to self-rated confidence?	Pearson correlation	Two scale variables, linear	r = _____, r^2 = _____	_____	_____
Robustness check on the ordinal item	Wilcoxon signed-rank	Ordinal data, normality failed	z = _____	_____	_____

Key Findings & Implications

1. **Reach.** Smart Partner has reached _____ % of Year 1 students. — state the headline number
2. **Who uses it most.** Adoption and frequency differ by EAP level: _____. — report the direction of the gap
3. **How it is used.** _____ dominates feature use, while _____ is used least. — practice versus planning
4. **Why it is used.** Motivation is predominantly exam-oriented, with habit-building lagging behind.

> **Implication.** The agent is currently positioned as an exam-sprint tool. To realise its long-term learning value, the _____ function should be strengthened and promoted to core-stream students.

Reflection & Next Steps

What went wrong

- Convenience sampling left the foundation and advanced cells thin, so equal-cell comparison was impossible.
- Pilot testing exposed ambiguous wording in the frequency item.
- Self-reported frequency and duration carry recall bias.
- A cross-sectional design cannot separate cause from effect.

What we would change

1. Stratified sampling with quotas per EAP level.
2. Cross-validate against server-side usage logs.
3. Add a longitudinal pre/post measure of confidence.
4. Targeted interviews with High Level students.

Ethics. Participation was voluntary and anonymous, with an information sheet and consent form completed before every response; results are reported in aggregate only.

Thank you

Questions & Answers — 3 minutes

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Full instruments, consent documents and analysis plan are in ADS401_GroupC_Presentation2SupplementaryMaterials.pdf